Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, January 25, 2021 at 6:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Land Acknowledgement

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 6:02 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session (6:03 p.m.)

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (d) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss a matter pertaining to labour relations or employee negotiations.

CARRIED

3.1 Ajax Fire Association Grievance

Open Meeting (7:00 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In-Camera

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That all action approved during the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

4. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the following Minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting December 14, 2020
- Special Meeting January 6, 2021

CARRIED

5. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no items of correspondence had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

6. Delegation and Presentations

6.1 Proclamation: Durham Region Hospice Awareness Day – January 29, 2021

Donna McFarlane, Chair, Durham Region Hospice – Whitby, delivered a presentation regarding Durham Region Hospice Awareness. D. McFarlane provided an overview of the number of hospice beds in Durham Region, supports available in Hospices, and a status update on the Whitby project including an overview of the budget, and fundraising efforts to date.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate to D. McFarlene and proclaimed January 29, 2021 as Durham Region Hospice Awareness Day in the Town of Ajax.

6.2 Gift of Health & Wellness from the Town of Ajax to Ajax Pickering Hospital

Tracy Paterson, CEO, Ajax Pickering Hospital Foundation, thanked members of Council and staff at the Town of Ajax for their continued support. T. Paterson delivered a presentation on the renovated sitting room and cafeteria at Ajax Pickering Hospital to serve as a gathering place for families, patients, and staff, and reviewed the features of the new space including furniture, televisions, artificial fireplace, and cafeteria.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked T. Paterson for her presentation.

7. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence Items 7.2, 7.3, 7.6, 7.7, 7.8, 7.10, 7.13, 7.14, 7.15, 7.16, 7.17, 7.19, 7.20 and 7.21 for discussion.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the balance of the report (Items 7.1, 7.4, 7.5, 7.9, 7.11, 7.12, and 7.18) dated January 25, 2021 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 7.2

Members discussed the Ajax Public Library Board's decision to move to a fine-free model, the Library Grant, budget impacts, and services provided to the community. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Members of Council.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: Mayor Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Item 7.2 of the Correspondence Report "Ajax Public Library Board – Letter of Correspondence to Council" be referred to the February 8, 2021 Capital & Operating Budget meeting.

CARRIED

Item 7.3

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.3 of the Correspondence Report "Region of Durham - Bill 229, Protect, Support and Recover from COVID-19 Act" be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 7.6

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.6 of the Correspondence Report “Region of Durham - Lake Simcoe Solution” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.7

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.7 of the Correspondence Report “Region of Durham - Notice of Motion Minister's Zoning Orders” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.8

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.8 of the Correspondence Report “Region of Durham - Regulatory Framework to Manage the Operations of Anaerobic Digestion Facilities” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.10

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.10 of the Correspondence Report “Township of Brock - Addressing Racism & Inequalities” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.13

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.13 of the Correspondence Report “Township of Uxbridge - “Red – Control” COVID-19 Restrictions in Durham Region” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.14

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.14 of the Correspondence Report “City of Hamilton - Temporary Cap on Food Delivery Service Charges” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.15

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.15 of the Correspondence Report “City of Kitchener - Cannabis Retail” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.16

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.16 of the Correspondence Report “Municipality of Marmora & Lake - Bill 229” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.17

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.17 of the Correspondence Report “Region of Peel - Federal and Provincial Support for Adequate Paid Sick Day Benefits” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.19

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.19 of the Correspondence Report “Town of Kingsville - Letter of Support for Small Businesses” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.20

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.20 of the Correspondence Report “Town of Orangeville - Bill 229 Resolution” be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item. 7.21

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 7.21 of the Correspondence Report “Township of Puslinch - Bill 229” be endorsed.

CARRIED

8. Reports

8.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated January 4, 2021, be adopted.

CARRIED

8.2 General Government Committee Report

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the General Government Committee Report dated January 11, 2021, be adopted.

CARRIED

8.2 General Government Committee Report

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the General Government Committee Report dated January 18, 2021, be adopted.
CARRIED

8.3 **Summary of Advisory Committee Activities**

Members of Council asked questions regarding the Durham Scarborough Bus Rapid Transit Program by Metrolinx including impacts on heritage properties, public communications, and an inventory of properties affected. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Members of Council.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated January 25, 2021, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.
CARRIED

8.4 **Departmental Reports**

None

9. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillors provided an update regarding the Toronto Global contract and the COVID-19 vaccination plan.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Regional Councillors' Report of January 25, 2021 be received for information.
CARRIED

10. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the rules of procedure be suspended to introduce a motion without notice regarding Funding Sick Leave.
CARRIED
on 2/3rds

10.1 **Ravenscroft Road**

Councillor Tyler Morin and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Councillor Tyler Morin and Regional Councillor Crawford responded to questions on the motion from Council Members. John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, noted that the Town of Ajax has an All-Way Stop Warrant system and provided an overview of the process.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS traffic speeds on Ravenscroft Road have been an ongoing issue for many years;

AND WHEREAS in 2019, while completing the Traffic Calming Warrant Update, staff implemented traffic calming bollards on Ravenscroft Road as a pilot, and after review additional bollards were installed in 2020;

AND WHEREAS staff and Council continue to receive complaints about traffic speeds from residents along Ravenscroft Road;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Staff be directed to install all-way stop signs at the earliest opportunity, and without delay, at the following intersections:

   i. Ravenscroft Road and Radford Drive
   ii. Ravenscroft Road and Brennan Road

2. Staff be directed to bring forward the necessary amending by-law to the Town's Traffic by-law at a future meeting of Council.

CARRIED

10.2 **Exploring a TOA Rodent Control Rebate Program**

Councillor Bower and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS The experience of increased rodent (specifically rats and mice) sightings is shared by residents and businesses in all growing municipalities across the Greater Toronto and Hamilton Area (GTHA) as rodents' habitats are reduced or disturbed by development;

AND WHEREAS Members of Ajax Council continue to receive calls and correspondence from residents concerned about rodent control, particularly in areas which are undergoing redevelopment, with a total of 31 formal complaints received (in addition to numerous informal complaints) in the past two years;

AND WHEREAS Rodent control falls under the Town's Property Standards By-law, which applies only if there is clear evidence of an infestation (the presence of an unusually large number of insects or animals in a place, typically so as to cause damage or disease), and nuisance issues are the sole financial responsibility of the home or business owner;

AND WHEREAS a number of Ontario municipalities have recently begun offering a rodent control rebate program (at least four municipalities have established such programs since 2018);

AND WHEREAS Ajax Council wants to support residents experiencing significant increased sightings and nuisance issues on their properties which appear to be as a result of development factors in their neighbourhoods;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Staff be directed to report back to Council or the appropriate Standing Committee with information to consider the development of a residential rodent control rebate program (or pilot program) in advance of the 2021 construction season, including information about:
   - Program administration, including bill-back to developers
   - Conditions to qualify for a rebate;
   - Monitoring requirements;
   - Evaluating the success of the rebate program;
   - Best practices among other municipalities; and
   - Potential financial impacts

CARRIED

10.3 **Investment Portfolio Report**

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: A. Khan

WHEREAS municipal investments are governed under O. Reg. 438/97 (eligible investments, related financial agreements and prudent investment) of the *Municipal Act, 2001,* which was updated (expanded) in early 2018;

AND WHEREAS Council deems it expedient to reassess the Town's investment strategy

to explore options that may increase the Town's overall rate of return while managing risk to taxpayer money for long-term benefits;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that staff be directed to investigate investment strategy options (including ONE Investment and other opportunities), identify areas of improvement, and report back on the benefits and risks of multiple options to the May 2021 General Government Committee meeting.

CARRIED

10.4 **Endorsement of Joint Project for ICIP: COVID-19 Infrastructure Program**

Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

WHEREAS the Governments of Canada and Ontario launched a $1 billion funding program for broader public sector infrastructure investments to assist in the recovery from the COVID-19 pandemic, including a $250 million sub-stream for municipalities;

AND WHEREAS The Government of Ontario has assigned maximum funding allocations to all 444 municipalities based on factors, including median household income, population size and value of infrastructure;

AND WHEREAS the Town of Ajax was allocated up to a maximum of $746,614 in funding, and subsequently, submitted five projects for approval on January 7, 2021, including $250,000 for the Kingston Road and Salem Road Wetland Restoration project;

AND WHEREAS the Region of Durham has submitted an application for $500,000 towards the estimated cost of the 'wetland restoration project;

AND WHEREAS the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority identified the 'wetland restoration project' on Town property in the lower reaches of the Carruthers Creek for marsh and riparian habitat restoration estimated at $750,000;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT: Council authorize staff to engage in negotiations and agreement development process with the Region of Durham, the provincial Ministry of Infrastructure and Infrastructure Canada, to comply with any terms for joint projects set forth in the final contribution agreement, pending successful applications.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

10.5 **Funding Sick Leave**

Regional Councillor Lee introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS COVID-19 infections continue to climb, and it remains critical that all levels of government identify and fill gaps in containment measures in order to curb the spread;

AND WHEREAS while current lockdown measures have been successful in helping to reduce the number of infections across the province, but many in essential workplaces are still unable to choose not to go to work when sick, a known barrier to COVID-19 reduction;

AND WHEREAS the Federal Government's Canada Recovery Sickness Benefit provides after-tax support of $450 per week for those who are sick or need to self-isolate due to COVID-19, but the fund takes time to access and doesn't cover many workers' full wages;

AND WHEREAS the Provincial Government has extended the Infectious Disease Emergency Leave for the first half of 2021, which makes it easier for employees to take the necessary time off, but does not assist with compensation;

AND WHEREAS a primary or sole income earner in a household may not enjoy the privilege of being able to reduce their salary and/or wait for support;

AND WHEREAS the Ontario's Big City Mayors has requested that the Governments of Canada and Ontario move swiftly to provide longer, better funded sick leave to help address the ongoing spread of COVID-19;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council request that the Governments of Canada and Ontario work collaboratively to increase current support programs to provide longer and funded sick leave for those who do not already have access through their employer; and

2. That this motion be distributed to the Hon. Mark Holland, MP, Rod Phillips, MPP, the Region of Durham, Durham Region municipalities, Ontario's Big City Mayors, and the Association of Municipalities of Ontario.

CARRIED

11. By-laws

Members of Council asked questions regarding the Boulevard Tree By-law and the Road Occupancy By-law. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law numbers 02-2021 to 08-2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

12. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Crawford indicated that she and Regional Councillor Lee will be bringing forward a motion requesting that the Government of Ontario phase out provincial gas fired power plants by 2030 to the February meeting of Council.

13. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members thanked Inspector Mitch Martin of DRPS West Division for his actions and involvement in the community in response to recent incidents.

Council Members highlighted upcoming events and activities including a Medallion development Open House on Thursday, January 28, 2021, a community Ward 1 meeting on February 16, 2021, virtual Open Houses for the Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan in February, and Open Houses for Driveway Zoning By-law Amendments on February 9, 2021.

Council Members reminded residents to stay home during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Mayor Collier expressed deepest sympathies to the family, friends and colleagues of Brock Township Mayor Debbie Bath-Hadden, and noted that flags at Town facilities are lowered to half-mast.

14. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That By-law number 09-2021 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on January 25, 2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

15. Adjournment

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the January 25, 2021 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (8:13 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

_____
D-Clerk